

UnleashTheBox

42 meet Hackthebox

Summary: An immersive cybersecurity project where participants learn to exploit systems and acquire essential skills to navigate the dynamic world of information security.

Version: 2.0

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Chapter I

Introduction

Welcome to the exhilarating world of cybersecurity! Are you ready to embark on an adventure into the depths of hacking and penetration testing?

Have you ever dreamt of mastering the art of exploiting systems? Now is your chance to turn that dream into a reality. The realm of cybersecurity offers an array of challenges where you'll learn to navigate and exploit vulnerabilities in various systems.

HackTheBox provides an immersive platform that simulates real world scenarios for you to practice your skills. You'll encounter a diverse range of systems waiting to be breached, from web applications to network infrastructures.

The process of mastering the art of exploitation requires dedication and continuous learning. You'll gain knowledge in discovering weaknesses, analyzing vulnerabilities, and crafting exploits. As you progress, you'll develop a deep understanding of the techniques used by hackers to secure systems and protect against attacks.

So, why wait?

Begin your journey today and dive into the captivating world of cybersecurity. Prepare to face exciting challenges and elevate your skills to new heights.

Chapter II

Objectives

As a participant in this project, your main objective is to professionalize yourself in the field of cybersecurity. Your goal is to reach a minimum seasonal tier on HackTheBox that demonstrates a solid foundation of skills and competencies in infosec.

Throughout this project, you will be challenged in various areas, such as mastering different hacking techniques, understanding network security, and analyzing vulnerabilities. You will also gain practical experience in penetration testing and secure coding practices.

This project requires critical thinking and problem solving skills, pushing you to explore and adapt to the constantly evolving landscape of cybersecurity. By actively participating, you will develop valuable skills and knowledge that will enhance your expertise in the field.

By achieving the set objectives, you will not only gain the necessary skills to thrive in the world of cybersecurity but also become part of a community of professionals dedicated to safeguarding digital assets and systems.

Are you ready to embrace this challenge?

Let's get started!

Chapter III

Mandatory Part

III.1 Preparation



You can't retry this project, and that's expected and normal.

Before starting this project, you need to create an account on the HackTheBox website.

To create your account, go to the HackTheBox website and use the interface to create your account.

You must use your **student email address**. Your login should follow the format: `pseudo42`.



For example, if you chose "wil" as your pseudonym, your login on the website should be wil42.

Once your account is ready, follow the two sections below in order: first get familiar with the platform through the Tutorial, then move on to the Seasons section where the project will actually be validated.

III.2 Tutorial Section

Before jumping into seasonal Machines, get familiar with the platform.

Use the Starting Point labs to learn about the tools you'll need and how to install the VPN required to reach the various resources.

III.3 Seasons Section

Once you are ready, head to the HackTheBox Seasons section.

A Season is a 13-week competitive cycle during which HackTheBox releases one brand new Machine every week. Your goal is to become root on these seasonal Machines: each Machine grants two flags (*user* and *root*), for a total of 26 flags per Season. Flags only count toward your tier progression if you submit them while the corresponding Machine is still in its active week (no farming retired seasonal Machines).

As you submit flags during a Season, you progress through five **tiers** (Bronze, Silver, Ruby, Platinum, Holo):

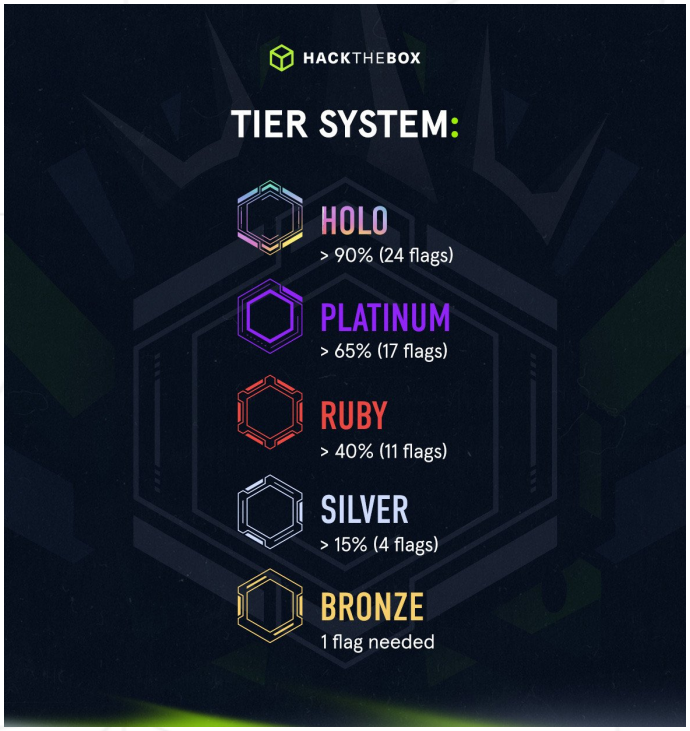


Figure III.1: HackTheBox seasonal tier system

Once a tier is reached, its badge is **permanently** stored on your public HackTheBox profile, even after the Season ends. **The seasonal badge on your public profile is the source of truth for this project**: if the required tier badge is visible on your profile, the corresponding criterion is validated, regardless of when it was earned or whether the Season that issued it is still running. The evaluator does not check anything else.



HackTheBox runs Seasons one after the other: a new Season starts shortly after the previous one ends, so there is always one running. Because tier badges are permanent, you do not need to start at the beginning of a Season to validate this project, and you do not need to finish your target tier within a single Season. This project simply adapts to HackTheBox's own release cycle. If you join while a Season is already running, focus on the Machines still to come. If you do not reach your target tier in time, just keep going during the next Season. Any past or current Season counts.



A VIP account is **not required**: free users can play every weekly seasonal Machine through the *Release Arena*, and all five tiers are accessible to everyone, regardless of subscription. That said, students who do wish to subscribe to VIP can benefit from a **20% discount** through our partnership with HackTheBox. Please contact the pedago staff at your campus to obtain the discount code.



It is strictly **forbidden** to attempt seasonal Machines with more than one person, and it is forbidden to publish any information about them, as stated in the HackTheBox rules. In case of suspicion, there will be repercussions.

III.4 Objective to Achieve

To complete the mandatory part of this project, your goal is to reach the `Ruby` tier (11 seasonal flags) in any HackTheBox Season.

It is entirely possible to validate this project with a lower tier, yielding a partial grade:

`Silver` tier (4 flags): you will receive 20% of the maximum grade.
`Ruby` tier (11 flags): you will receive 100% of the maximum grade.

The `Bronze` tier (1 flag) is too low to validate any part of this project: it is shown in the table above only because it exists on HackTheBox, not because it counts here.

Once you have reached at least the `Silver` tier, you will need to push a file named "login.txt" to your repository. This file must include the login you used and your student email address. Additionally, please make sure to add the URL of your **public** profile (the URL that works in a browser without being logged in, of the form `https://app.hackthebox.com/public/users/<id>`):

```
$> cat login.txt
wil42,wil@42.fr,https://app.hackthebox.com/public/users/926
$>
```



The profile shown above is an old account used here only as a formatting example. Do **not** copy these values - replace them with your own login, your 42 student email, and the URL of your own public HackTheBox profile.



You need to put your profile in public, not in private. The evaluator must be able to see your seasonal tier badges without logging in.

Chapter IV

Bonus part

To validate the bonus part you simply need to reach the `Platinum` tier (17 seasonal flags) in any HackTheBox Season.

It's easy, isn't it? :)



`The bonus part will only be assessed if the mandatory part is PERFECT. Perfect means the mandatory part has been integrally done and works without malfunctioning. If you have not passed ALL the mandatory requirements, your bonus part will not be evaluated at all.`

Chapter V

Submission and peer evaluation

Turn in your assignment in your `Git` repository as usual. Only the `login.txt` file inside your repository will be inspected during the defense, along with your live HackTheBox public profile. Carefully check the name and the contents of `login.txt` to ensure they match the format above.